

BANASTHALI VIDYAPITH

Foundation Course (Universal Human Values)

Common for all UG students

Session- December, 2024 - May, 2025

Course Handout

Course Code: BVF019

Course Title: Dr. Aparna, Dr. Arti Kumari, Dr. Ruchi, Dr. Shikha Sharma, Dr. Rajshree Mathpal, Dr. Tarique, Dr. Srishti.

Course-in-Charge: Dr. Rajshree Mathpal, Dr. Ruchi, Dr. Srishti, Dr. Tarique Iqbal.

Classes: B.Sc./B.Sc.B.Ed. Maths/Biotech./Bio. VI Sem./B.Sc. Home Science VI Sem.

Time Table: As per Schedule

Learning Outcomes: After the completion of the course, the students will be able to:

- Know about universal human values and understand the importance of values in individual, social, career, and national life.
- Become conscious practitioners of values.
- Realize their potential as good human beings and conduct themselves in the ways of the world

Course Content

Truth: Universal truth, Truth as value, Truth as fact (veracity, sincerity, honesty amongst others); narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/ folklores about practicing truth, advantages of practicing truth.

Love: Forms of love: for self, parents, friend, spouse, community, nation, humanity and other beings (living and non-living), gratitude and forgiveness; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing love, advantages of practicing love.

Compassion: Concept and meaning, empathy, sympathy and non-violence: role models in history for practicing compassion including Mahatma Gandhi; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing compassion, advantages of practicing compassion.

Service- Concept of service (Sewa) as a value, forms of service: for self, for parents, family, elderly and debilitated, friend, spouse, community, persons in distress or affected by disaster, nation and humanity; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing service, advantages of serving the needy.

Renunciation (Sacrifice): Concept of renunciation and sacrifice, self restraints, ways of overcoming greed; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing renunciation, advantages of practicing renunciation.

Well being: Concept and importance; kinds of well being: physical (endurance, strength), emotional (ability to respond to emotions and control them), aesthetic (ability to see and appreciate beauty in all beings), intellectual (rationality and logic), relational (obligation to self, parents, family, society, nation, humanity, living with others and acceptance), moral (difference between good and evil, practicing goodness, righteousness), spiritual (thinking beyond self and journey from senses to spiritual level). Integral human well being- Inter related of different kinds of well being, integration of mind, body and soul; importance of yoga and pranayama in attaining integral well being.

Recommended Books

1. Mookherji, R.K. (2016). *Ancient Indian Education*. (8th edition). Motilal Banarasidass.
2. Ghosh, S.K. (2004). *Universal values*. The Ramkrishna Mission, Kolkata.
3. Goel, A & Goel, S.L. (2008). *Human values: Principles and practices*. Deep and Deep Publications pvt. Ltd., Delhi.
4. Verma, V.P. (1977). *Nitishastra ke mool sidhant*. Allied Publishers pvt. Ltd, New Delhi.
5. C. R. Synder, Shane J. Lopez, Pedrotti, J.T.(2011). *Positive Psychology (The Scientific and Practical explorations of Human Strengths)*. SAGE.
6. Steve, B., & Marie, C. (2013). *Positive psychology*. Pearson Education India.
7. Cornelissen M, Misra G, Varma S (2013) *Foundations and applications of Indian psychology*, 2nd Edition.
8. Rao, K. R., & Paranjpe, A. C. (2016). *Psychology in the Indian tradition*. Springer Science + Business Media. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-81-322-2440-2>
9. Mookerji Radha Kumud, *Ancient Indian Education*, Motilal Banarasidass.
10. Joshi Rokeach (1973). *The Nature of Human Values*. New York: The Free Press.
11. Patra, Avinash (2012), *The Spiritual Life and Culture of India*, Oxford University Press.
12. Shantikumar Ghosh, *Universal Values*. The Ramakrishna Mission, Kolkata, 2004.

Suggested e-Resources

1. Universal truth
<https://www.lifehack.org/articles/lifestyle/life-truths-17-universal-truths-all-share.html>
2. Truth as value
https://www.jstor.org/stable/40269061?seq=1#metadata_info_tab_contents
3. Love
<https://greatergood.berkeley.edu/topic/forgiveness/definition>
<https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2019.01425/full>
<https://aktu.ac.in/hvpe/PDF%20Presentations/PDF%20English%20Presentation/HVPE%202.3%20Und%20Relationship%20-%20Justice.pdf>
<https://www.thrivingmind.org/loving-your-family-your-friends-and-yourself-everyday/>
4. Connect with empathy and lead with compassion – Retrieved from
<https://hbr.org/2021/12/connect-with-empathy-but-lead-with-compassion>
5. narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/ folklores about practicing truth
https://www.maxwell.syr.edu/moynihan/sac/The_Ramayana_A_Telling_Of_the_Ancient_Indian_Epic/
6. Concept of Sewa
<https://sewajyoti.com/CONCEPT-OF-SEWA>
7. Forms of Service: Community
http://himalaya.socanth.cam.ac.uk/collections/journals/opsa/pdf/OPSA_03_05.pdf

8. Well-being
<https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/click-here-happiness/201901/what-is-well-being-definition-types-and-well-being-skills>
[https://www.researchgate.net/publication/297363075 Sri Aurobindo's vision of integral human development Designing a future discipline of study/citation/download](https://www.researchgate.net/publication/297363075_Sri_Aurobindo's_vision_of_integral_human_development_Designing_a_future_discipline_of_study/citation/download)
[https://magadhuniversity.ac.in/download/econtent/pdf/Psychology%20in%20the%20Indian%20Tradition%20\(%20PDFDrive.com%20\).pdf](https://magadhuniversity.ac.in/download/econtent/pdf/Psychology%20in%20the%20Indian%20Tradition%20(%20PDFDrive.com%20).pdf)
9. Compassion
<https://hbr.org/2021/12/connect-with-empathy-but-lead-with-compassion>
10. Concept of renunciation and sacrifice, self restraints
<https://upanishads.org.in/upanishads/sa/ishaupanishad/chapter-ii-the-golden-rule-of-living-enjoyment-and-renunciation>

Course Plan

Lecture No.	Topic	Recommended Book/ e-Resources
1-2	Orientation	
3-7	Truth- Universal truth, Truth as value, Truth as fact (veracity, sincerity, honesty amongst others); narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/ folklores about practicing truth, advantages of practicing truth.	RB-3, RB-4 ER-1, ER-2, ER-3
8-12	Love – Forms of love: for self, parents, friend, spouse, community, nation, humanity and other beings (living and non-living), gratitude and forgiveness; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing love, advantages of practicing love.	RB-5, RB-6, ER-3
13-17	Compassion- concept and meaning, empathy, sympathy and non-violence: role models in history for practicing compassion including Mahatma Gandhi; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing compassion, advantages of practicing compassion.	RB-14, ER-9
18-22	Service- Concept of service (Sewa) as a value, forms of service: for self, for parents, family, elderly and debilitated, friend, spouse, community, persons in distress or affected by disaster, nation and humanity; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing service, advantages of serving the needy	RB-1, RB-2 ER-3, ER-4, ER-5
23-27	Renunciation (Sacrifice)- Concept of renunciation and sacrifice, self restraints, ways of overcoming greed; narratives and anecdotes from history and literature/folklores about practicing renunciation, advantages of practicing renunciation	RB-1, RB-2. RB-3, ER-5, ER-10
28-32	Well being- Concept and importance; kinds of well	BR-7, BR-8, BR-9,

	being: physical (endurance, strength), emotional (ability to respond to emotions and control them), aesthetic (ability to see and appreciate beauty in all beings), intellectual (rationality and logic), relational (obligation to self, parents, family, society, nation, humanity, living with others and acceptance), moral (difference between good and evil, practicing goodness, righteousness), spiritual (thinking beyond self and journey from senses to spiritual level). Integral human well being- Inter related of different kinds of well being, integration of mind, body and soul; importance of yoga and pranayama in attaining integral well being	BR-10, BR-11, BR-12, ER-7
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Abbreviations: RB: Recommended Books, ER: e-Resources

The following components will constitute the continuous assessment.

Component	Marks	Submission/ Examination date	Allotment
Home assignment I	20	27 January, 2025	Topics shall be allotted in the class by 8 January 2025
Home assignment II	20	5-8 February, 2025	Topics shall be allotted in the class by 12 February, 2025
Semester Examination	60	19 April- 5 May, 2025 *	--

*subject to change